

How to Use Your Self-Employment Tax Calculator

SKU TAX-008 • SELF-EMPLOYMENT TAX CALCULATOR

Walks through the IRS Schedule SE flow — net SE income $\rightarrow 92.35\% \times \rightarrow 15.3\%$ (12.4% Social Security + 2.9% Medicare + 0.9% Additional Medicare on high earners) — and outputs the half-SE-tax adjustment that reduces your AGI.

Important: SE tax exists on Schedule C income, not Schedule E. If your STR is passive (no substantial services), you do NOT owe SE tax. If you're providing concierge, daily cleaning during stays, or meals, your CPA may file you on Schedule C — and that triggers this calculator.

Wizard flow (8 tabs)

Two files:

- **DEMO** — Sarah's example: \$43K Schedule C net, MFJ, no W-2. Expected total SE tax = ~\$6,075.
- **BLANK** — your numbers.

Step 1 — Net SE Income (tab 1)

Three inputs:

- Schedule C net profit
- Schedule F (farm) net
- Partnership SE income (Box 14A on K-1)

Sum these. If total $< \$400 \rightarrow$ no SE tax (de minimis exception).

Step 2 — Wage Base & W-2 (tab 2)

- Your W-2 wages + tips this year
- Spouse W-2 wages (if both have SE income)

The 2026 Social Security wage base is **\$176,100**. If your W-2 already exceeds it, you owe NO Social Security portion (still owe Medicare).

Step 3 — SE Tax Calc (tab 3)

All computed:

- NESE (net earnings from SE) = SE income $\times 92.35\%$

- SS portion = $\text{MIN}(\text{NESE}, 176,100 - \text{W-2 wages}) \times 12.4\%$
- Medicare portion = $\text{NESE} \times 2.9\%$ (no cap)

Step 4 — Adjustments (tab 4)

- Filing status (drives the Additional Medicare 0.9% threshold)
- Single threshold: \$200K · MFJ: \$250K
- Computes Additional Medicare on NESE + W-2 above the threshold

Step 5 — Schedule SE Map (tab 5)

Auto-built mirror of Schedule SE Part I + Part II. **Print this** for your CPA.

Step 6 — Launch (tab 6)

Total SE tax (Schedule 2 Line 4) + half-SE-tax adjustment (Schedule 1 Line 15 — deductible above the line, reduces AGI).

Reading the output

- **Total SE tax** — what you owe on top of income tax. Add to your quarterly estimateds (TAX-005).
- **Half-deductible adjustment** — reduces your AGI. CPA enters on Form 1040 Schedule 1.

At tax time

Hand your CPA the Schedule SE Map tab. They transcribe to the actual form.

Questions?

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